Lesson 4

SANCTIFICATION

Aim: To teach the Biblical concept on the doctrine of Holiness.

Introduction:

Welcome back to One Life! Our subject for today is very relevant to what is currently happening to our times. The recent calamities are a proof that we are in these last days. The book of Peter reminds us of what kind of people we ought to be in these end times.

2 Pet 3:10-13

10 But the day of the Lord will come like a thief. The heavens will disappear with a roar; the elements will be destroyed by fire, and the earth and everything in it will be laid bare.

11 Since everything will be destroyed in this way, what kind of people ought you to be? You ought to live holy and godly lives

12 as you look forward to the day of God and speed its coming. That day will bring about the destruction

of the heavens by fire, and the elements will melt in the heat.

13 But in keeping with his promise we are looking forward to a new heaven and a new earth, where righteousness dwells.

This is a very important subject, for *Hebrews 12:14* says,

14 "Follow peace with all men, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord: "

In **Regeneration** *our nature is changed*, in **Justification** *our standing is changed*; In **Sanctification** *our character is changed*. Sanctification shows the fruit of as justified life. It is the will of God for every believer and mentioned 1066 times in the Bible.

1 Thessalonians 4:3

3 For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication:

Let us journey together as we study this topic to prepare ourselves for the coming of the Lord.

THE MEANING OF SANCTIFICATION

Sanctification is the work of the Holy Spirit. Holiness and Sanctification are the same in essence. The basic meaning of Sanctification is "separation".

Greek Word ***"hagiasmos"*** the process of making or becoming holy, set apart; sanctification, holiness, consecration.

Psalm 4:3

3 Know that the Lord has set apart the godly for himself; the Lord will hear when I call to him.

Believers have been set apart by God for the Lord to use as He desires. The Bible meaning of Sanctification **" is to be set apart"** by God, for God, from Sin unto a holy life.

Hebrews 12:14, 2Timothy 2:21

The Bible speaks of sanctifying the Tabernacle and its contents: men, buildings, fields, firstborn, temple, priests and a nation.

Exodus 40:9-11 , Leviticus 27:14-17 , Numbers 8:17

THE AUTHOR OF SANCTIFICATION

The Blessed Trinity.

1. *By God The Father. 1 Thessalonians 5:23-24*

2. *By God The Son.Ephesians 5:26-27*

3. *By God The Holy Spirit. 2 Thessalonians 2: 13*

Dr. Griffith Thomas said, *"holiness is not an achievement to be accomplished, but a GIFT to be ACCEPTED"*

THE MEANS OF SANCTIFICATION

How are we sanctified?

1. **By The Word of God.**

John 17:17 , Romans 10:17

To be sanctified, spend much time with the Word of God. It purifies and cleanses. John 16:8

While listening to God's Word, the Holy Spirit is beginning to convict the heart of the person. 1 John 1:9

After being convicted, we confess.

2. **By The Blood of Jesus. Hebrews 13:12**

The Word reveals sin; the Blood cleanses away, result is Sanctification.

3. **By Chastisement. Hebrews 12:10-11**

God disciplines us for our good- to make us holy.

4. **By Yielding to God. Romans 6:19**

We are exhorted to offer our bodies to God in holiness.

5. **By ourselves. 2 Corinthians 7:1**

We, too, have a part in sanctification. Our part is seeking out the sin, casting it away, praying for cleansing, prayer for strength to live a holy life

TIME OF OUR SANCTIFICATION

There are great diversities of opinion here.

Some say that it was completed the moment we believed, being synonymous with conversion. Others stress the need of a second work of grace, an experience quite separatefrom conversion. Some treat it as a crisis experience that eradicates the old nature. Others teach that Sanctification is instantaneous and progressive.

1. **Instantaneous with Conversion.**

1 Corinthians 6:11

It speaks of sanctification as a past experience with washing and justification.

2. **Progressive.**

James 1:22-25

Faith in action, progressively; we have to do what

the Word says, including our holiness.

The Holy Spirit does not reveal all of our unchristian-likeness at one time, that would be too discouraging and would lead us to despair. The moment that something is revealed we should seek cleansing and continuously pursue a path of progressive sanctification.

3. **Complete and Final.**

1 Thessalonians 5:23

Someday we will be completely holy without one grace missing, mature and perfect. This wonderful experience will be ours when Christ comes and our bodies are changed. Then we shall be like Him.

1 John 3:2

-Perfect and holy

Paul was pressing on towards that future perfection, while daily perfecting his earthly progressive sanctification.

THE RESULT OF SANCTIFICATION

1. **Perfection through Christ**

   Hebrews 10:14

2. **The Fruit of holiness**

   Romans 6:22

HOW TO RETAIN A SANCTIFIED WALK

1. ***Live a life of implicit obedience to the light given to you by the Holy Spirit.***

2. ***If you fail, immediately confess it to God and He will instantly restore you.***

3. ***Resist the devil and he will flee from you.*** James 4:7

4. ***Be faithful in regular seasons of Bible reading, prayer, witnessing and living for others.***

CONCLUSION

Daily, we must appropriate Christ as our sanctification, daily we must claim His holiness, His death, His faith, His love and His grace. The secret of a holy life is the continuous appropriation of the Savior's holy life. Our degree of sanctification is in relation to our appropriation of the Lord.

1 Thessalonians 5:24